Maksym Hotko

AI Automation Engineer · AI agents · workflow automation · LLM evaluation

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SUMMARY

AI Automation Engineer with 3 years of turning manual work in sales, marketing, HR and operations into production systems. I build end to end: n8n, Make and Zapier workflows, Python services, LLM agents with tool calling and RAG, and the evaluation loop that keeps them accurate (golden sets, benchmarks, drift monitoring). I came from sales and led a sales team, so I map a process with the people who run it before I automate it. Claude Code is my daily environment; I build my own MCP servers.

EXPERIENCE — PROJECTOR (EDTECH, KYIV)

AI Automation Engineer

Jul 2025 – Present

I own AI and automation for sales, marketing, HR and operations end to end: process mapping with team leads, build, launch, documentation and monitoring. Every project below was designed and built by me.

- **AI sales-call QA.** Sales calls are transcribed (Ringostat → Python service on Cloud Run + Gemini, speakers split by stereo channel) and scored by Claude on a 23-criterion rubric, with results in Notion and weekly Slack digests per manager. ~95% of valid calls are now scored, vs about 20 calls per rep a month reviewed by hand, with no significant time from the sales lead.
- **LLM evaluation loop.** Prompts are managed as code: a versioned rubric in Git, human-labelled golden sets, a benchmark stand, scripted deploys and weekly drift alerts per criterion. Built Prompt Lab (FastAPI, Docker, company SSO) to test prompt changes against human labels before every deploy.
- **Sales lead routing.** Rebuilt the routing system on n8n and extended it: four workflows send every new deal, consultation request and missed call to the next available rep on the right team, least recently assigned and within working hours. The sales lead controls rotation from a Google Sheet; per-course exceptions are one table row.
- **Meta Ads creative alerts.** A daily n8n monitor across two ad accounts flags creatives that burn budget. Thresholds are per course, from 12-month CPL, and were designed on historical data (Poisson analysis). Marketers get a Notion card and stop/keep buttons in Slack, with reminders and a feedback loop. First month: ~$1,600 of spend pulled from underperformers, ~$650–850 net savings.
- **Migrations off Zapier and Make.** Replaced 143 per-course Zaps with four n8n workflows around one routing sheet, covering all 61 live courses: routing to reviewers, Pipedrive deal matching, email-thread linking and a daily self-healing check. Moved bank-payment parsing (LLM) and other scenarios from Make, fixing silent defects found on the way (duplicate records, dropped batches).
- **Nexi, HR assistant in Slack** for ~105 employees: a Python agent with tool calling, RAG over 165 policy pages (recall@12 93%), an employee directory synced from PeopleForce and an automated performance-review cycle. 313 tests, separate prod and dev, deploys with automatic rollback.
- **Mentorship tools.** A Slack bot matches a mentee's free-text request to ~560 active mentors (BigQuery + questionnaire data + LLM-written mentor profiles): support spends 2 minutes per request instead of 7–15, about an hour a day saved. A Telegram bot on the WLaunch booking API shows mentors their bookings, stats and reviews; rescheduling and availability editing are in pilot.
- **B2B sales.** Built Apollo-based lead-generation automations to source B2B clients, and an AI agent that handles inbound partnership requests from companies: it analyses each request against the current course catalogue, proposes matching programs, and helps the sales team build a tailored training program and client presentation (live, early results).
- **Community and marketing tools.** LLM anti-spam for Telegram chats (benchmark: 14 of 18 spam messages caught vs 5 before, 0 false positives); a competitor ad scanner (Python + Apify); a BigQuery → Sheets plan/fact budget dashboard per marketer.
- **Reliability.** One error pipeline for n8n and Make (Notion incident log, deduplication, alert throttling); a five-page documentation standard for every automation; a self-hosted VPS (Docker, Traefik, TLS, nightly backups).

Automation & AI Specialist

Jun 2024 – Jul 2025

- Built Make and Zapier systems for lead tracking, deal distribution and reporting; cut response time 3× and removed manual routing.

- Launched 15+ GPT-based assistants for admissions and HR, cutting deal cycles from 7 to 3 days and lifting conversion by 10%.
- Shipped internal AI tools (email assistant, Telegram bot) and live dashboards for leadership.
- Built the first AI call-transcription flow, later rebuilt as the QA pipeline above; started the Career and Performance Review AI assistants.

Sales Operations Lead

Feb 2024 – Jun 2024

- Automated Pipedrive workflows, cutting repetitive actions from minutes to seconds, and moved pipeline management from manual updates to automation.
- Built internal tools and integrations that improved CRM data accuracy and team communication.
- Hiring manager and team lead: interviewed and hired sales managers (one is now a top performer), handled a dismissal, led the sales team for several months and covered for the Sales Lead.

Sales & Support Manager

Oct 2022 – Feb 2024

- Ran full B2C and B2B sales cycles: 3,200+ deals worth UAH 61.65M at 73% conversion.
- Built 20+ CRM dashboards for analytics and performance tracking.
- Built early automation prototypes that were later scaled company-wide.
- Mentored and onboarded new sales managers.

SIDE PROJECTS

- **Custom MCP servers.** A read-only Meta Marketing API server for ad analytics inside Claude, and a personal-finance assistant over the Monobank API (22 tools, 202 tests, daily sync, Google Sheets mirror).
- **Claude Code operating setup.** My daily work environment: persistent memory, custom skills and scheduled agents (morning brief, deadline review) over Notion, Google Calendar and n8n.
- **Freelance lead generation.** Built a lead-generation system for an external client in the DACH market, run entirely from a Google Sheet: industries, titles, company sizes, locations, scoring weights and all prompts. n8n searches Apollo, skips leads from earlier runs, enriches each lead with Apollo, LinkedIn and Perplexity web research, scores it against three buyer personas, repeats until the client's target of qualified leads is reached (100 to 1,000 per run), and drafts personal messages with Claude. Separate workflows test prompt changes on a fixed lead sample.

SKILLS

- **AI and LLMs:** Claude (API, Claude Code, MCP), OpenAI, Gemini, Perplexity; agents with tool calling, RAG, structured outputs; LLM evaluation with golden sets, benchmarks and drift monitoring
- **Automation:** n8n (primary), Make, Zapier; webhooks, HTTP/REST APIs, OAuth2
- **Code and infrastructure:** Python, JavaScript, Google Apps Script, SQL (BigQuery); FastAPI, Docker, Google Cloud Run, Linux VPS, Git
- **Tools:** Notion, Airtable, Google Sheets, Looker Studio, Pipedrive, Zoho CRM, Salesmate, PeopleForce, Slack, Typeform, SendPulse, Apollo, Lemlist, Clay (basic), Meta Marketing API
- **Ways of working:** fix the process and data before automating, success criteria before building, priorities by impact for time spent, logging, documentation and error handling by default, hiring and team leadership

EDUCATION AND LANGUAGES

- Ivan Franko National University of Lviv — Entrepreneurship, Trade and Exchange Activities, 2021–2023 (not completed)
- Courses at Projector: AI for Product Creation, Product Management Beginning, SMM for Business
- Ukrainian — native; English — B2, conversational